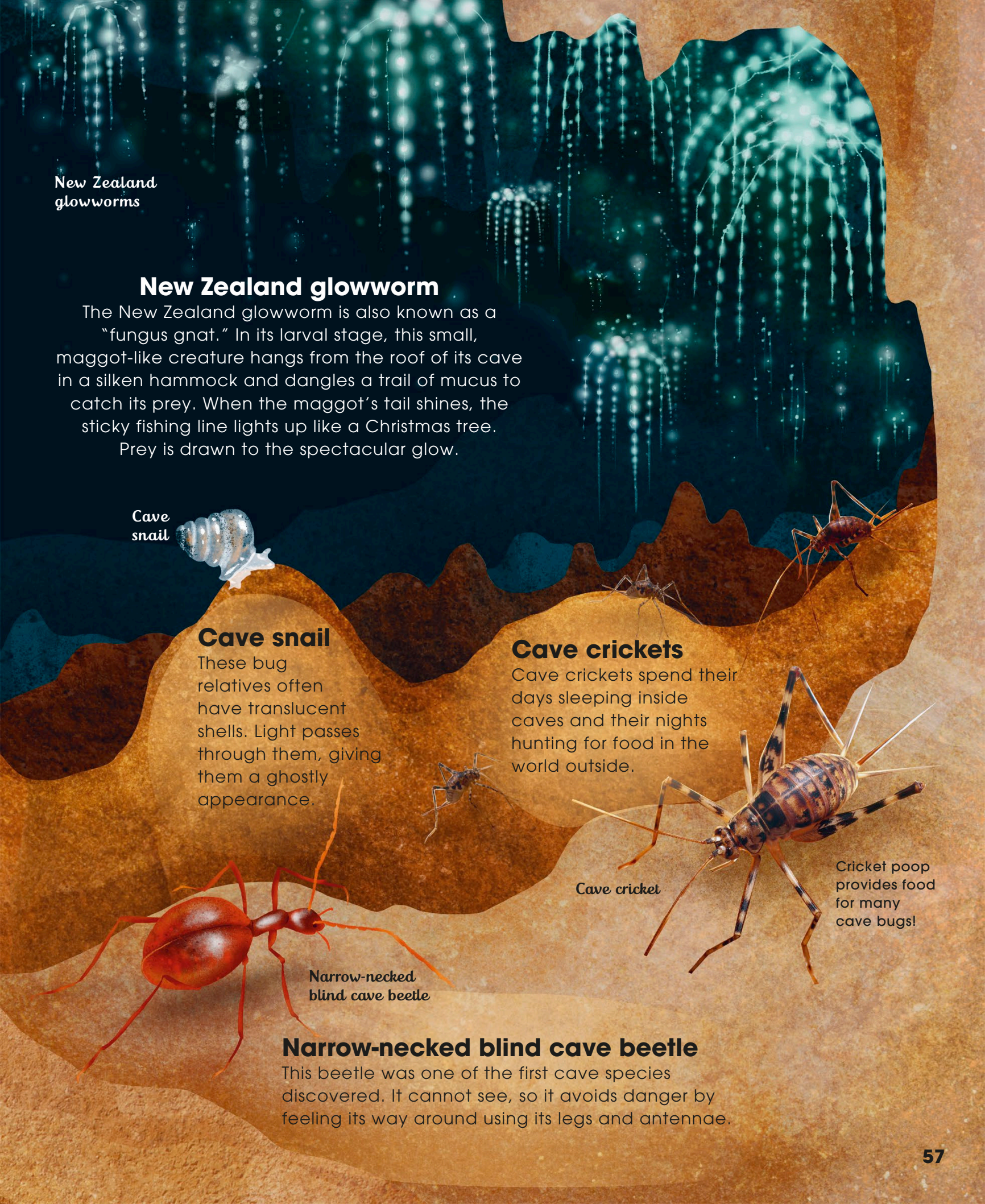




New Zealand
glowworms

New Zealand glowworm

The New Zealand glowworm is also known as a "fungus gnat." In its larval stage, this small, maggot-like creature hangs from the roof of its cave in a silken hammock and dangles a trail of mucus to catch its prey. When the maggot's tail shines, the sticky fishing line lights up like a Christmas tree. Prey is drawn to the spectacular glow.

Cave
snail

Cave snail

These bug relatives often have translucent shells. Light passes through them, giving them a ghostly appearance.

Cave crickets

Cave crickets spend their days sleeping inside caves and their nights hunting for food in the world outside.

Cave cricket

Cricket poop provides food for many cave bugs!

Narrow-necked
blind cave beetle

Narrow-necked blind cave beetle

This beetle was one of the first cave species discovered. It cannot see, so it avoids danger by feeling its way around using its legs and antennae.